“Something is fundamentally wrong with me.”

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Where it often comes from

Struggling with anxiety, depression, trauma, or other conditions can lead us to see ourselves as defective. Shame and comparison to “normal” people harden into a core belief that something deep inside is broken.

What Scripture teaches

“I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made.” “For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust” (Psalm 103:14). “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit.” Jesus said, “It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.” Struggling does not make you defective. We live in a fallen world with bodies and minds affected by it, and God’s love is not reduced by it. Help exists and healing is possible.

> *“For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust”* (Psalm 103:14).

Also see

> “I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well” (Psalm 139:14).

> “The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit” (Psalm 34:18).

> “Jesus answered, ‘It is not the healthy who need a doctor, but the sick.’” (Luke 5:31).

> “He heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds” (Psalm 147:3).

Common self-statements

- I am defective.
- Normal people do not feel this way.
- I was made wrong.
- Something is deeply broken in me.
- I do not belong with healthy people.
- I am the problem.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either normal or defective.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that I will never be okay.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling broken and concluding that I am.
- Labeling: Calling myself defective.

Challenging questions

- What does “wrong with me” actually mean?
- Who taught me to see struggle as defect?
- Would I call a friend with the same struggle defective?
- What does God say about how I was formed?
- What help have I sought or could I seek?

- What strengths do I also have?

Truth summary

> I am fearfully and wonderfully made, and my struggles are not a verdict on my worth. God remembers how I am formed, loves me, and provides help. I can seek care without shame.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Depression, Symptoms of
- Therapy
- God, Creator
- Guilt/Shame

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Self-Esteem, Low
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "Something is fundamentally wrong with me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something is fundamentally wrong with me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What does "wrong with me" actually mean?
- ☐ Who taught me to see struggle as defect?
- ☐ Would I call a friend with the same struggle defective?
- ☐ What does God say about how I was formed?
- ☐ What help have I sought or could I seek?
- ☐ What strengths do I also have?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ I am fearfully and wonderfully made.
- ☐ God remembers I am dust.
- ☐ The Lord is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ The sick need a doctor.
- ☐ Help is available.
- ☐ I am not defective.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 103:14
  "For He knows our frame; He is mindful that we are dust."
- ☐ Psalm 139:14
  "I praise You, for I am fearfully and wonderfully made. Marvelous are Your works, and I know this very well."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Not defective: Each week, note one strength and one step of care.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 103:14 becomes: "Sarah can write: "God remembers how I am formed and loves me.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Self-Esteem, Low" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] List your strengths. Write ten things you do well.
- [ ] Seek help. Talk to a doctor or counselor.
- [ ] Speak kindly. Replace "wrong with me" with "struggling with."
- [ ] Pray Psalm 103:14. Rest in God's understanding.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something is fundamentally wrong with me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Not defective
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something is fundamentally wrong with me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You know how I am formed. Remove my shame, give me help, and let me see myself as You do. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.